National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, Islamabad

FAST School of Computing

HEALTHY ROOTS, STRONGER FUTURE

Submitted By:

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Bachelor of Computer Sciences

Date of Submission: 5th December, 2025

Visiting Lecturer: Ms. Iqra Nazar

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Author's Declaration

We, Muhammad Mughees Tariq Khawaja, Muhammad Mustafa, Abdul Moeed, Muhammad Sarim, Anas Mumtaz, and Ahmad Zakwan, hereby state that our Civics and Community Engagement project titled "Healthy Roots, Stronger Future" is our own work and it has not been previously submitted by us for taking partial or full credit for the award of any degree at this university or anywhere else in the world. If our statement is found to be incorrect, at any time even after our graduation, the University has the right to revoke our degrees.

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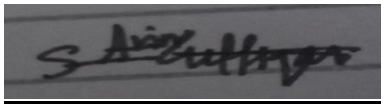

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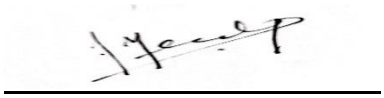

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Plagiarism Undertaking

We take full responsibility for the work conducted during our Civics and Community Engagement project titled "Healthy Roots, Stronger Future". We solemnly declare that the work presented in this project is done solely by us as a group with no significant help from any other person; however, small help wherever taken is duly acknowledged. We have also written the complete report ourselves. Moreover, we have not presented this project or any substantially similar work or any part of this project previously to any other degree awarding institution within Pakistan or abroad.

We understand that the School of Computing of National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences has a zero-tolerance policy towards plagiarism. Therefore, we as authors of the above-mentioned work solemnly declare that no portion of our report has been plagiarized and any material used in the project from other sources is properly referenced.

We further understand that if we are found guilty of any form of plagiarism in our project work even after our graduation, the university reserves the right to revoke our bachelor's degrees.

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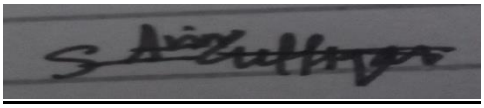

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Dated: 4th December 2025

Executive Summary

"Healthy roots Stronger Future" represents an eight weeklong community service initiative that was undertaken by six Computer Science students from FAST University, Islamabad. This project was undertaken at the Ashiana-e-Korang Orphanage, in Korang Town, Islamabad. The main objective of this project was to nurture emotional, social and educational, along with spiritual development of about thirty-five children, all aged between 5-15 years of age. The visits occurred weekly for about 8 weeks from September to November 2025.

This project was balanced around several activities designed to address different aspects of the children's development. These activities included games, conversations, learning and moral/ethical discussions, conduction also indoor and outdoor sports sessions, facilitation art and drawing activities as well. And ending it all with a farewell filled with gratitude and reflection for both the children and the students.

Our approach was rooted in Ethical principles of service, especially to one's own community as their responsibility. Even as Muslims, according to the Prophet Muhammad's (PBUH) teachings also served as a foundational philosophy through this journey. Every activity was designed with not only a focus on entertainment but also education, provided through practical means. Values such as respect, teamwork, patience, discipline and gratitude were prioritized.

The project aimed to directly contribute to the United Nations SDGs. Mainly the SDG's targeted were SDG-3 (Good health and well-being) by helping and promoting sports and healthy competition, SDG-4 (Quality Education) by providing them with moral lessons of course, but also to inspire them to study well and teaching them to improve their education and understanding overall, SDG-10 (Reduced Inequalities) by giving them the same treatment regardless of their backgrounds and by providing consistent attention to children from marginalized backgrounds who rarely see such opportunities. And finally, SDG-16 (Peace, Justice and Strong institutions) by teaching them strong moral and ethical values such as respect, peace and honesty.

This outcome of this project extended beyond our expectations, for the children at the orphanage, we witnessed that this project not only helped them feel more confident in themselves but also increased their self-expression, academic understanding in subjects they struggled and also helped them in viewing their physical education in a new light, with more of an emphasis on lessons learned and qualities developed such as teamwork etc. They also developed a deeper connection and understood the significance of education and the benefits of it. For us volunteers, it also had a major impact, it allowed us to view life in a more profound way, to understand the blessings we have and to be grateful for them. We understand the reality of the struggles faced by those who lack these privileges and how they face these realities, with bravery and courage. It was not only inspirational but also taught us humility, gratitude and a sense of discipline. And above all, it strengthened our commitment to community service.

Throughout these eight weeks, we had to face various challenges, including having to adapt plans when various external circumstances changed. We also had to deal with a varied age gap, including children from 5 years up to 15. From grade 4 to even some in F.Sc, maintaining consistent energy and enthusiasm throughout this journey. And, to be responsible, fair and kind in our dealings with them. These challenges taught us resilience, patience and flexibility in the face of such challenges so we can say they were beneficial to us as well beyond simple course requirement.

This report documents our complete journey week by week and serves as a reflection of our journey throughout these 8 weeks, the ethical and moral considerations we maintained and the specific impacts we observed. It also tells of the lessons we learnt. It served as not only an academic requirement but also as a personal testament to the wonderful ability of community engagement, especially when approached with sincerity and consistency.

Acknowledgements

We would first like to appreciate the individual and institutions that made it possible through their support.

First and foremost, we thank Allah Almighty for giving us this opportunity, health and guidance. Every moment spent with the orphans reminded us that this project is a service to humanity commanded by the Almighty.

We would also like to appreciate and thank Ms. Iqra Nazar, our course coordinator, for her continuous guidance, encouragement and support throughout this entire process. Her willingness to stand by us when required and providing constant guidance gave us confidence and helped us approach this project with dedication and sincerity.

We would also like to appreciate the staff at Ashiana-e-Korang for their support. We would like to thank them for welcoming us into their home and allowing us to not only serve the children, but also for giving us the freedom to approach this service as we desired. They were very helpful and extremely supportive throughout this. Their support was instrumental to the success of this project.

We are also extremely grateful to the wonderful children at the Ashiana-e-Korang Orphanage for not only opening their hearts to us and giving us a chance, but remaining respectful, disciplined throughout this activity. The children were extremely kind, respectful and supportive of our activities. They not only never rejected our approach but were also extremely attentive and enthusiastic in participating. Their gratitude, discipline, behavior and resilience served as a guiding force for us all.

We also acknowledge our families who not only supported us throughout this process but actively encouraged and even financially participated in this. They understood the significance of this project and helped us throughout serving as another source of motivation for the members.

And finally, we thank all the members of this team for always taking time out of their tough study schedules and their cooperation and coordination which led to making this project such a success.

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1.INTRODUCTION

"Healthy Roots, Stronger Future" isn't just a formal community service, but rather a collective mission for us to bring the education, norms, and knowledge of the modern world and its challenges to a group of underprivileged kids.

1.1 Background and Context

Ashiana-e-Korang is not a very large-scale orphanage but rather a very grounded, grassroots one that operates out of home-based setup. Located in Korang Town, Islamabad, with a focus on growth and discipline, it shelters approximately thirty-five orphans aged under 15 years old. They focus on fostering a homely environment with a large emphasis on imbuing ethical and moral values in the children. They also focus on the children's academic and spiritual development.

1.2 Project Objectives

The main objective of this project "Healthy Roots, Stronger Future" was to establish a meaningful relationship with the children of Ashiana-e-Korang Orphanage and to educate them in meaningful methods. We wanted to boost their confidence and self-expression. We also placed a large emphasis on physical education and well-being along with the academic and Ethical education. Even for us volunteers ourselves, it helped us develop practical skills such as teaching, communication and management. It also helped us develop a sense of empathy and teach us about community service.

1.3 Need Assessment

The need for this project became clear to us in our initial meeting with the head of the organization, during our discussion, we learnt that the orphanage was only visited sometimes by the occasional donors. It mainly operated on a very tight budget. Just from the meeting, we identified several needs such low self-esteem among the children, lack of confidence and for some, even the lack of future aspirations as they were not very aware of the path available for them. We felt that they deserve as much as everyone else. It was observed that the children were very well-behaved and disciplined but they had limited opportunities to truly express themselves without hesitation, as they were not very comfortable with the head due to the strict environment. So, they also needed someone to lend them an ear. And hence, it became clear to us that we were supplementing orphanage management with a focus on emotional care and moral guidance.

1.4 Alignment with Sustainable Development Goals

At the very beginning, our project was very much aligned with United Nations Sustainable Development Goals.

***1.4.1. SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being*:** It was a primary focus throughout our project. We not only targeted the mental well-being of the children by communicating with them and performing activities such as drawing, story sessions and discussions, but also on their physical health through exercises, sports and indoor games as well.

***1.4.2. SDG 4: Quality Education*:** It was addressed throughout the project in various dimensions, such as academic, ethical, moral and physical. The education provided was tailored to specific ages and grade levels to make sure no one was left out. We also taught them beyond the classroom using films, sports and other fun activities etc.

***1.4.3. SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities*:** It was perhaps our most significant target as we aimed to provide all the children with similar opportunities despite their background, age etc. We helped them realize their opportunities, provide them with attention and mentorship, even with emotional support to reduce that inequality they face.

1.4.4. SDG 16: Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions: It were supported throughout this project with our focus on moral education and values. We focused on instilling values such as kindness, peace, patience and forgiveness and created an environment focused on fostering these values. By helping them internalize these values in their formative years, we contributed to their future development as responsible citizens.

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2. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The eight-week timeline of this project was planned carefully and meticulously to not only suit our schedules but also to help in the development of the children and focus on their internal growth. We would visit the orphanage each Wednesday from 2 pm to 4 pm as the children arrived back from school. This consistent schedule helped foster a sense of anticipation and routine for the children.

2.1 Week 1: Building Rapport and Understanding

Week 1 was our initial meeting with the children. Our focus for this week was mainly on breaking the ice between us and the children and helping develop a sense of familiarity with them. Now as this was our first official visit, we were first greeted by the head of the institution. He explained to us the workings of the institution, its background and its foundational beliefs. He explained the struggles of the organization and how the children went about their daily lives.

After that meeting, we officially met the children, who at the time were very shy and hesitant. We first observed how young the children were and how much of an age gap they had, a detail that would help us go forward with the planning of our activities. There were approximately 35 children in total ranging from the ages of 4-15, from preschool to Matric.

So, we then began our very first week by first introducing ourselves, our background, our purpose and also gave them the opportunities to introduce themselves as well. We discussed their hobbies, inspirations, and other things such as their interests etc. After that, we officially began our first activity in which we divided our group to engage with them more personally, discussing stories with them, listening to their stories and background, and some of us even engaged in little games such as Hand-Cricket.

These little activities proved to be very fruitful as they helped ease that initial tension. By the end of the day, the children had become much more responsive and active in participation whenever we would ask them a question or have any sort of discussion. Also in this first week, we targeted SDG-03 by providing them with opportunities for discussion and expression.

2.2 Weeks 2 and 3: Creativity and Confidence Building

Now that the foundation had been laid in the first week, we continued to build upon it in the following two weeks.

2.2.1. Week 2: Talent Show & Roleplays

We started off strong in week 2 by engaging them in a game of sit & stand. This helped energize them for the day. The main activity for this day was a talent show followed by roleplays.

At first the children were hesitant to perform and needed that initial push, but as the elder ones began to go upfront and began showcasing their talents, it also inspired the younger ones to gain more confidence and showcase theirs as well. We started off by one of them reciting a Naat. Then we began witnessing more and more talents such as some showcasing their reading skills, others marching like soldiers, some even showcasing their 'kung fu' skills. It created a very light and encouraging environment for them.

After that, we began the roleplays. We split the children into groups of 6-7, each guided by a group member of ours. Then we would guide them with various roleplays, each embedded with a central moral lesson. After that, we would perform one-by-one in front of them. Some were funny, some more focused, but all of them just as important as one another. After we finished, we discussed with them the importance of those central moral values and their roles in our daily lives. This week was focused on SDG-04 by providing quality education through practical methods.

2.2.2. Week 3: Movie Screening

This week, we jumped into a screening of the movie '3 Bahadur'. A movie chosen by the members for its strong focus on morals and ethics teaching important values such as teamwork, facing hardships and aspiring big.

The children were very excited just hearing about the plan and were very interested throughout the screening, watching it with great interest. After the film was over, we sat down for a discussion with the children and discussed with them the values discussed in the film and how we can implement them in our daily lives, focusing even on the relationships between them as well. This week targeted SDG-04 by providing a unique learning opportunity for development outside of a typical classroom through entertainment.

2.3 Weeks 4 and 5: Sports and Creative Expression

Weeks 4 and 5 brought new dimensions to our engagement through physical activities and artistic expression. These sessions tested our adaptability and revealed deeper layers of the children's personalities and values.

2.3.1. Week 4: Indoor Games

Week 4 was where we faced one of our first major challenges. Originally, we planned an outdoor activity of sports. We even discussed it with the children who were very excited at the prospect. But we then found out the park was inaccessible due to an event that was taking place so we had to adapt and change our activity to one of indoor games.

We played many games such as indoor Cricket, Carrom Board, mini-Football game, Badminton, Qaidi taara and even musical chairs, all arranged according to age. We had a lot of fun in this activity but also, we did not lose our focus and at the end, we had a discussion with them regarding the sports, the significance of physical health and values such as teamwork, resilience and sportsmanship. In the process, targeting SDG-03 and SDG-04.

2.3.2. Week 5: Creative Arts

Week 5 was the week centered around self-expression for each of the children, as this week, we focused on expression through art. We bought pencils, colors and Sketchpads for the children. When we arrived there, we gave all of them the materials needed and allowed them to draw whatever the pleased. The children were very excited and immediately took to the papers, their little canvases. They worked hard and drew as their beautiful, little hearts desired. In the end, we had a hefty set of drawings made by each of them. Some drew landscapes, some houses, some cars, boats, birds, planes, some even famous characters like Iron Man.

Week 5 reinforced learning through more creative methods and encouraged them to display their artistic talents more often.

2.4 Week 6: Physical Activity and Unity

Week 6 was where we placed the activity we had originally planned for Week 4 as this was the one the children were most excited for, the sports day. We took the children to a Zoo (that also served as a park) that was about a 30- minute walk from the Orphanage. When we arrived there, despite the long walk, the children were full of energy. So, we split them into various groups based on who wanted to play which game. Most came down to Football, and cricket. Some went to observe and play with the animals present at the zoo (under our vigilance of course). So, we once again split, each group member joining one of the games and guiding them.

The children had loads of fun playing the games, and it was also quite nice to see that they got along well. After the games were over, the children were surprisingly still very excited and full of energy, something that deflated a bit when we reminded them of the long walk back. Regardless, we can state that this week turned out very fruitful.

Once again, this week primarily focused on their physical development and ethical nourishment.

2.5 Week 7: Islamic Education

In week 7, our focus shifted towards the spiritual side. Our activity for this one was focused on the spiritual development of children. This week, we decided to share Islamic teachings with the children and discuss with them the lessons learned. We started it off with a story faith, one that teaches us how to view the creator, Allah Almighty. The story of the Prophet Ibrahim (AS) and the fiery pit. Then, we followed it up by a story discussing how to treat Allah's creations. We discussed the story of the sinful woman who was forgiven just for feeding water to a thirsty dog. The children listened to these stories very attentively and gave us a very positive response when asked of the lessons learned.

After that, we also had a talk with them regarding Geography. As the children were very interested in locations related to ancient stories, so we showed them a lot of famous locations (such as the Colosseum, Roman Arches, Mesopotamian Architecture, Ancient Arab architecture etc).

Once again, we targeted SDG-04 for spiritual education as well as SDG-11 as we provided them with interesting information they would not usually be able to find.

2.6 Week 8: Academic Support, Farewell and Reflection

Week 8 was perhaps our most emotional and important one, we started this week off by first splitting up the children into groups focused on their grades (pre-Grade 4, Grade 4-6, Grade 7-8, Grade 9 and above) each containing one or two of our members as well. Then we began helping them out with their academic struggles. We also decided to take into consideration difficulties we could not help them with in the future and decided to teach them various ways to approach certain issues in their studies. We taught them various subjects like Mathematics, Physics, Science, Chemistry and of course, our specialty, Computer.

After that, before the final farewell, we decided to share a meal with them. We arranged Biryani for the children. It also served for us a source of humility, teaching us about their humble lifestyle and also the privileges we have. To be grateful for what we have been blessed with and to use it to bring joy to others. In that moment, we realized the true spirit of community service.

2.7 Timeline and Resources

The visits lasted from mid of September to mid of November, where we visited every Wednesday after classes due to the availability of all members. This lasted for about eight weeks. As for resources, the most important and frequently recurring one was of transportation, which would cost us on average about 2500-4000 PKR for every visit. Then there was the factor of material we bought, including sketchbooks, pencils, colors, football, cricket bat/ball, badminton shuttle, which totaled to about 5000 PKR. And also, the last meal which cost us about 12000 PKR, totaling up to about 37000-40000 PKR across all members, coming up to about 6000-7000 PKR per each member. We paid for it out of our pocket and did not rely on any form of donations or ask from the institution.

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3. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

Ethical considerations were certainly among the foundations of our project as we were dealing with a demographic which required a heightened sense of ethical responsibility and consciousness.

3.1 Informed Consent and Confidentiality

Confidentiality and consent were made clear on our very first day. Even before we visited, we stated our full intent to the orphanage without leaving any room for misunderstanding. We stated who we were, what we were doing, what discussions needed to be had and how we would go about doing our project. The organization wholeheartedly accepted our terms.

Even when we met the children, we gave a full, lengthy introduction to make sure the air was clear between us from any confusion. They understood who we were and what sorts of activities they would be engaged in throughout this journey. Even during the activities, we did not force any child to participate in an activity they did not wish to participate in.

We also understood the significance of the power dynamics in play and the pressure on the children, so we decided to always make it clear verbally that no one had to take part in anything they disliked. They were also encouraged to speak up against something they did not find acceptable. Fortunately for us, no such dispute came up. We acted with them as elder brothers, guiding them as friends rather than with authority. We also always allowed them to speak their minds and deal with all of them equally and without discrimination.

3.2 Cultural and Religious Sensitivity

We understood the significance of the religious environment of the orphanage we visited so we had to behave accordingly, we respected the culture they had and shaped our activities accordingly. We did not facilitate any needless secular frameworks, and we also made sure no activity violated the principles of Islam. For example, in the week for Arts, the children did not draw faces on animals as they found it to be something going against the teachings of Islam, so, we did not force anyone to partake in that. We also treated them with respect, and rather than look down upon them, we encouraged them where needed to explore and grow with whatever opportunities they may find in life.

We also tried to be very polite in our communication and remained sensitive to their emotional vulnerabilities. We understood the significance of communication and made no compromise on it. We also made sure no sensitive information shared with us was shared among the children. We also maintained this behavior with the orphanage organizers as well.

3.3 Environmental Sustainability

We were quite sensitive regarding environmental sustainability during our project. We made sure to purchase and use material that would not be wasted. We also made sure to teach them to clean after every activity to make sure they understood the significance of cleanliness. We also took into consideration SDG-12 (Responsible Consumption) during our last meal to make sure no food was wasted.

3.4 Compliance with Ethical Standards

We adhered to ethical standards throughout the entire process. We made sure our intentions were transparent and clear. We also maintained regular updates and feedback on our activity from the orphanage management to make sure that we could always serve the children better. We treated all the children equally, no matter their ages, skin tone, background or any other factor, no child was left out, everyone was treated the same and we also made sure no child had to face any form of humiliation or difficulty, between themselves and us.

4. OUTCOME AND IMPACTS

The fruits of Healthy Roots, Stronger Future were much wider than weekly activities. The project had an emotional, academic, social, and moral impact on the children and it also redefined our personal perception of service. Its results were to be noticed not only in the session but also in the manner the children were able to behave, interact as well as learn in the following weeks.

Children can directly benefit from the outcomes here since they may develop variable skills in their own physical, mental, and social development.

4.1 Direct Child Outcomes:

The outcomes here can directly benefit children because they may cultivate variable skills concerning their physical, mental, and social growth. The children were the most affected and the most significant consequence of the project. During the eight weeks, we saw significant improvements in confidence, academic activity, emotional health, and social interaction of the students, both subtle and more noticeable.

4.1.1 Emotional and Psychological Development

Upon meeting the children, some of them seemed embarrassed or insecure to talk or seemed not to know how to communicate. Week 3 and they were running at us as soon as we came so that they could talk and be involved. This is because they felt comfortable since we would meet regularly. Constant interaction is especially necessary in the case of children who have been the subject of inconsistency and our presence offered a sense of predictability and reliability.

Minor but significant effects such as complimenting a child on a drawing or congratulating on a good shot in cricket raised their self-esteem. They started to start discussions, exchange stories, and consult. Their comfort that has grown over them was transferred into evident joy: increased laughter, vitality, and belonging.

4.1.2 Academic Improvement

As we took new students in as tutors, many children had difficulties with strong mathematics basics. These concepts were simplified by means of providing grade instructions, instruction using objects, drawings, and real-life examples. Children who had been afraid of multiplication tables were able to solve the problems with confidence.

Science tutoring was especially beneficial to older children in the 7-9 grade levels. Suddenly, the explanation of such concepts as force, pressure, and chemical reactions made sense, when they were described using simple experiments and analogies with which people can relate themselves. A number of children kept on posing

educational questions even after the session had been completed- indicating actual curiosity and willingness to learn.

4.1.3. Physical and Recreational Development

Sporting activities offered a much-needed energy, coordination and social bonding. The remarkable stamina and cohesion were manifested in Week 6, with the long walk and outdoor sports day. The children demonstrated teamwork, equity and discipline-all the qualities that are imperative in personal growth.

Exercise is associated with positive mood, increased sleep, less stress, and increased concentration. These positive results were noticed with the help of tutoring in the subsequent weeks- the children were more attentive, balanced, and present.

4.1.4 Social and Moral Behavior

Throughout the project, we have observed that there was a gradual rise in cooperation between children. The older children were guiding the younger ones and mediating small conflicts in a peaceful manner when it was needed during activities. At the farewell supper their order was marvelous--to eat first, be thankful, not wasteful.

Activities as roleplays and Islam storytelling enhanced their knowledge of such virtues as honesty, patience, forgiveness, and respect. These tales were not mere lectures but rather a form of teaching true values which can form as a part of their personality.

4.2 Contribution to Sustainable Development Goals

Our project played a significant role in various SDGs in both practical and long-term impact. The impact of the company on sustainable development goals is outlined below:

4.2.1 SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being

We promoted:

- sporting activities.
- positive attention as emotional well-being.
- predictability in the form of psychological stability achieved by weekly sessions.

These components aid in the growth of children in the comprehensive sense-as healthy mentally, physically and spiritually.

4.2.2 SDG 4: Quality Education

Children were provided with higher levels of education opportunities off-site through tutoring, story-based learning and confidence building exercises that are normally not offered to poor populations. We provided some explanations to create gaps that existed in crowded classrooms and lack of support after school.

4.2.3 SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities

Orphans are structurally disadvantaged. We minimized inequality in access to developmental opportunities by providing mentorship, emotional support, creative involvement and academic assistance.

4.2.4 SDG 16: Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions

Moral education, respectful relations, fair play and conversation about empathy and kindness all promoted attitudes that formed the basis of peaceful and ethically solid communities.

4.3 The Indirect Effects on the Community

The project also had ripple effects in the broader community besides the children.

- Staff members of the orphanage were thankful that regular visitors brought emotional strength to children and infused energy into them.
- College friends were interested in copying such projects.
- The families and friends of volunteers were sensitized on the need to support vulnerable children.
- Material recycling (sports gear, art materials) was maintained so that the effect would carry on after we left.

This project also showed that change need not necessarily be sustainable with funding but at times it only needs time, genuine intentions and dedication.

4.4 Individual Change of Volunteers

The project had a great influence on our lives as individuals.

4.4.1 Continued Empathy and Emotional Intelligence

The experience of closely working with orphaned children helped us realize our own privileges. We were taught to read between the lines, to be good listeners, and a good responder. Witnessing children being thankful to even the smallest gestures made us learn to be grateful and humble.

4.4.2 Skills in Communication and Teaching

The theory of explaining concepts to various age groups meant that there was need to simplify concepts and approach to instruction was different. This enhanced our thinking capacity and teaching facilities, which can be applied in any given profession.

4.4.3 Leadership, Teaming, and Accountability

To manage eight weeks of sessions, it was necessary to plan and organize logistically and coordinate and work as a team. We formed trust among ourselves, and every member contributed according to his or her strengths. Being flexible in potentially unfamiliar challenges, such as the change to indoor sports, enhanced our problem-solving skills.

4.4.4 Spiritual Growth

The Muslim doctrines were realized in this project. Values that we have read before such as kindness, charity, service, gratitude, turned out to be realities. The fact that we were contributing to the children was a spiritually rewarding experience, and it strengthened our relationship with faith.

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5. DISCUSSION

The eight-week journey was an experience that illuminated the aspects of community involvement, collaboration and self-development that could not be achieved in a classroom. This part is a reflection about the experience we had in the group, the skills we acquired and the obstacles that we faced.

5.1 Reflections on Group Experience:

Being a group of six required the use of communication, trust, and mutual responsibility. Our initial sessions demonstrated that we all have various strengths, one of us is good at teaching, another one is good at sports, yet

another one is good at planning or working with younger kids. The identification and exploitation of these strengths enabled us to operate well.

It was important to debrief after every session. We exchanged observations- e.g. which children required more academic focus, or which activities were best applied- and put changes into the following week plan. These consultations turned the project into dynamic and adaptive.

The project bonded us well as a team, emotionally. The common moments, such as the walk during Week 6 or the emotional farewells in Week 8, helped us to reach a deeper level and we will have the memories to remember long after university.

5.2 Skills and Insights Gained

The project developed the following important skills:

5.2.1 Adaptability

It was not always as planned- there was a lack of space at times, children were tired, or the weather came in. We were able to create sessions in real time and thus modify them rapidly, which was a great asset to us.

5.2.2 Patience

It took colossal patience to explain academic concepts to children and to arbitrate between quarrelling children or large groups of children. With time, we grew more relaxed and accommodating- attributes that we need in our career lives.

5.2.3 Cultural Competence

The project enlightened us on the Islamic ethics, cultural expectations and the psychological expectations of vulnerable children. It is this cultural sensitivity that will guide us to respond appropriately in the situations we encounter in the future.

5.2.4 Critical Thinking Social Issues

We started asking some wider system questions:

- Why do not orphanages have creative and emotional support?
- Why is academic help not always available to poor children?

- What does society need to do to construct structures to fill these gaps?

This consideration prompted us to think about past charity- to long term measures.

5.3 Difficulties Among the Problems and the remedies.

Work in the community is bound to come with difficulties. Among the significant problems, there were:

5.3.1 How to deal with Multiple Age Groups

There is no way a four-year-old and a fourteen-year-old can be engaged in the same manner. This was solved by splitting children into groups based on age or ability where it was needed, mainly in tutoring.

5.3.2 Time Limitations

Two hours a week were not enough. Our solution to this was by making sure that we planned high impact activities and made the best use of time.

5.3.3 Hesitation or Shyness during Early Weeks.

At first, some children did not like to take part. Gentle coaxing, being put in groups with other confident children and having low-stress tasks assisted them in opening up.

5.3.4 Emotional Attachment

Week 8 was difficult for both us and the children. We overcame this by making them feel assured that we appreciated the time we spent with them and that we would come to see them when we had time**.**

5.3.5 Resource Constraints

Our budget was very low. The answer was creativity, basic materials such as crayons, balls and storybooks created a huge effect when combined with significant interaction.

6. RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on our experiences, we offer very clear advice to help the students, universities, and the groups support children living in difficult and unsafe environments.

6.1 Recommendations for Future Student Projects

6.1.1 Value Consistent Care More

Children adapt themselves to the routine. Regular weekly visits help a lot instead of the rare one big event in a month.

6.1.2 Start with Observation

Do not push the early ideas. First learn or study the place, needs, and existing routines of the kids before planning all the activities.

6.1.3 As Simple as Possible

Kids often like some simple activities such as games, drawings, and stories. Always prepare backup plans.

6.1.4 Document Carefully, Not Excessively

Take very few photos when allowed to take and try to be active.

6.1.5 Final Meeting

Endings matter a lot. Always try to make the final meeting memorable and try to do your best in the final greetings.

6.2 Recommendations for University Administration

- Provide small funding to support the students for community projects.
- Give travel to the students and bit of relaxation of timings.
- Include the little bit of service in all courses not on a single course.

- Create a long-term link with the NGOS and orphanage houses.
- Give rewards to students for good services.

6.3 Recommendations for Orphanages and NGOs

- Create a simple volunteer program with simple rules.
- Ask the volunteers to stay longer visits not just short visits.
- Provide feedback to the volunteers so that they can improve their work.

Keep sharing resources with volunteers to lessen the burden on them.

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7. CONCLUSION

"Healthy Roots, Stronger Future" started as a single part of our Civics and Community Engagement course, but soon became a realized opportunity to share values and knowledge. This project taught us a fundamental truth: that your efforts pay off once your work becomes personal and you have a strong, inner care for it. We learned that real change comes not from just the running of activities or paying short visits, but it also comes from honest care, patience, and being true to your work.

We observed the inner growth of the children of Ashiana-e-Korang throughout these weeks. There was a huge difference in the levels of confidence, self-esteem, and other principles by the end of the project.

For us, it makes us happy and proud to know that we were able to instill values within an underprivileged community and that they'll be moving on forward with them now.

APPENDICES

Appendix A: Project Proposal

Project Title: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future

This project unites six students from Fast university and orphanage students in developing strong bonds through common activities at the orphanage. We will organize weekly sessions with mentoring and emotional support, gardening workshops, and educational activities according to the students' choice of interest. In mentoring, we'll sit with the kids, offering a listening and guidance session to help them navigate their feelings and set personal goals, fostering trust and confidence. Gardening will involve hands-on planting in the orphanage's outdoor space using available soil and seeds already on-site, teaching teamwork and a sense of accomplishment as they watch plants grow. The school program shall comprise interactive life skill workshops such as storytelling or games that are simple and only call for creativity and participation. The activities shall operate concurrently, with the orphanage students participating as they may feel appropriate, creating the ground for laughter and learning.

This project supports course goals of sustainable community development by taking a direct human interaction approach to meeting emotional and social needs, promoting SDGs such as Goal 3 (Good Health and Well-Being) through emotional support and Goal 4 (Quality Education) through skill-sharing workshops. Feasibility is simple, dependent on our time, energy, and the space already available in the orphanage, with an intended 8-week duration. There is no outside funding or donations involved; it's constructed out of our willingness to connect. We hope to leave the children with enhanced self-esteem and feeling of belonging and increase our own understanding of care in community through this project.

Appendix B: Approval Letter

National University
of Computer and Emerging Sciences

Certificate of Approval

To Whom It May Concern,

This is to certify that **Muhammad Mughees Tariq Khawaja, Muhammad Mustafa, Ahmad Zakwan, Muhammad Sarim, Hafiz Anas Mumtaz, Abdul Moeed of Fast University (CS-3A)**, has been approved to undertake a community work project as part of their academic requirements. The details of the project are as follows:

- **Organization Name:** Ashiana-e-Korang
- **Project Title:** Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
- **Duration of the Project:** 29th September, 2025 to 21st November, 2025
- **Time Commitment:** 8 weeks, 2 hours per week

The project aligns with the university's mission of fostering civic responsibility and providing experiential learning to the students, while also supporting the organization's initiatives. The students are expected to maintain professionalism and collaborate effectively throughout the project.

For any inquiries or further clarification regarding the project or the students' participation, please do not hesitate to contact the undersigned.

Thank you for your cooperation and support in this meaningful endeavor.

2/9/25

Ms. Misbah Zafar Iqbal
Officer Coordination Community Services
FAST, NUCES, Islamabad Campus
Email: misbah.zafar@isb.nu.edu.pk

Ms. Iqra Nazar
Lecturer (Community Service),
Department of Sciences and Humanities,
FAST NUCES, Islamabad Campus
Email: iqra.nazar.v@isb.nu.edu.pk

***Students should maintain and submit a copy of the letter to the following:**

- Course Instructor
- Course Coordinator

Appendix C: Acceptance Letter from Ashiana-e-Korang

ASHIANA E KORANG ORPHANAGE

Certificate of Acceptance

To Whom It May Concern,

This letter serves as formal confirmation that **Ashiana e Korang** has accepted the request from **Fast University** to involve **Muhammad Mughees Tariq Khawaja, Muhammad Mustafa, Ahmad Zakwan, Muhammad Sarim, Hafiz Anas Mumtaz, Abdul Moeed** in a community service project as part of their academic requirements. The project details are as follows:

- **Project Title:** Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
- **Duration of the Project:** 29th September, 2025 to 21st November, 2025
- **Time Commitment:** 8 weeks, 2 hours per week
- **Location:** Street Number # 7 House Number # 2 Korang Town Islamabad
- **Name of Supervisor:** Mehmoona As a Director

We believe this project will provide valuable experience to the student while contributing to the success of our ongoing initiatives. The student's progress will be closely monitored by **Mehmoona,** who will provide guidance and oversight throughout the project.
For any further inquiries, please feel free to contact the undersigned.

Head Name:Rafiq Essa
Supervisor:Mehmoona
Designation: Director
Organization Name: Ashiana e Korang
Contact Number: 0311-6806685
Email Address: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

0334-5538809
0311-6806685
ASHIANA E KORANG FOUNDATION®
House # 2, Street # 7, Korang Town, Islamabad.

***Students should maintain and submit a copy of the letter to the following:**

- Course instructor
- Course coordinator

ASHIANA E KORANG FOUNDATION

House # 27, Street # 2, Korang Town, Islamabad.
0311-6806685 0341-5116605 ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Appendix D: Meeting Record Form

National University
ofComputerandEmerging Sciences

Meeting Record Form

Civics and Community Engagement

Name of Organization: Ashiana-e-Korang
Name of Supervisor: Ms. Mehmoona
Title of Project: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
Name of student/s: MuhammmadSarim
Roll No./s: 24i-0668
Semester: 3rd
Contact Details of Supervisor: 0311-6806685
Email: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Progress and Meeting Record

No.	Date	Venue	Task Assigned	Signature of Supervisor
1	25-09-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang Town	Interviews & Ice breaking Session	
2	01-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang town	Storytelling, Roleplay & Talent Show	
3	08-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Movie Viewing	
4	15-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Indoor games	
5	22-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Creative Arts	
6	29-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Sports / Physical Education	
7	05-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Islamic stories & learning hour	
8	12-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Goodbye & celebrations	

National University
ofComputerandEmerging Sciences

Meeting Record Form

Civics and Community Engagement

Name of Organization: Ashiana-e-Korang
Name of Supervisor: Ms. Mehmoona
Title of Project: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
Name of student/s: Ahmed Zakwan
Roll No./s: 24i-0505
Semester: 3rd
Contact Details of Supervisor: 0311-6806685
Email: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Progress and Meeting Record

No.	Date	Venue	Task Assigned	Signature of Supervisor
1	25-09-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Interviews & Ice breaking Session	
2	01-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Story telling, Roleplay & Talent Show	
3	08-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Movie viewing	
4	15-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Indoor games	
5	22-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Creative Arts	
6	29-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Sports/Physical Education	
7	05-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Islamic Stories & learning hour	
8	12-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Goodbye & Celebration	

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National University
ofComputerandEmerging Sciences

Meeting Record Form

Civics and Community Engagement

Name of Organization: Ashiana-e-Korang
Name of Supervisor: Ms. Mehmoona
Title of Project: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
Name of student/s: MuhammmadMughees Tariq Khawaja
Roll No./s:24i-0806
Semester:3rd
Contact Details of Supervisor:0311-6806685
Email: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Progress and Meeting Record

No.	Date	Venue	Task Assigned	Signature of Supervisor
1	25-09-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang town	Interview & Ice breaking Session	
2	01-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang town	Storytelling, Roleplay & Talent Show	
3	08-10-25	Ashian-e-Korang	Movie Viewing	
4	15-10-25	Ashian-e-Korang	Indoor games	
5	22-10-25	Ashianae-Korang	Creative Arts	
6	29-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Sports/Physical Education	
7	05-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Islamic Stories & ~~Mathematical Education~~ learning hour	
8	12-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Goodbye & Celebration	

National University
ofComputerandEmerging Sciences

Meeting Record Form

Civics and Community Engagement

Name of Organization: Ashiana-e-Korang
Name of Supervisor: Ms. Mehmoona
Title of Project: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
Name of student/s: Anas Mumtaz
Roll No./s:24i-0653
Semester:3rd
Contact Details of Supervisor:0311-6806685
Email: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Progress and Meeting Record

No.	Date	Venue	Task Assigned	Signature of Supervisor
1	25-09-25	Ashiana-e-Korang, Korang town	Interview & Ice breaking session	
2	01-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang town	Storytelling, Roleplay & Talent Show	
3	08-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Movie viewing	
4	15-10-25	Ashiana-e-korang	Indoor games	
5	22-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Creative Arts	
6	29-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Sports / Physical Education	
7	05-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Islamic stories & learning hour	
8	12-11-25	Ashiana-e-korang	Goodbye & Celebration	

National University
ofComputerandEmerging Sciences

Meeting Record Form

Civics and Community Engagement

Name of Organization: Ashiana-e-Korang
Name of Supervisor: Ms. Mehmoona
Title of Project: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
Name of student/s: Muhammad Mustafa
Roll No./s:24i-0525
Semester:3rd
Contact Details of Supervisor:0311-6806685
Email: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Progress and Meeting Record

No.	Date	Venue	Task Assigned	Signature of Supervisor
1	25-09-25	Ashiana-e-Korang, Korang Town	Interview & Ice breaking Session	
2	01-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang Town	Storytelling, Roleplay & Talent Show	
3	08-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Movie viewing	
4	15-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Indoor games	
5	22-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Creative Arts	
6	29-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Sports / Physical Education	
7	05-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Islamic stories & learning hour	
8	12-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Goodbye & Celebration	

National University
ofComputerandEmerging Sciences

Meeting Record Form

Civics and Community Engagement

Name of Organization: Ashiana-e-Korang
Name of Supervisor: Ms. Mehmoona
Title of Project: Healthy Roots, Stronger Future
Name of student/s: Abdul Moeed
Roll No./s: 24i-0720
Semester: 3rd
Contact Details of Supervisor: 0311-6806685
Email: ashiana.home1@gmail.com

Progress and Meeting Record

No.	Date	Venue	Task Assigned	Signature of Supervisor
1	25-09-25	Ashiana-e-Korang Korang town	Interview & Ice breaking Session	
2	01-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang, Korang Town	Storytelling, Roleplay & Talent Show	
3	08-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Movie viewing	
4	15-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Indoor games	
5	22-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Creative Arts	
6	29-10-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Sports / Physical Education	
7	05-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Islamic Stories & ~~Moral Education~~ learning hour	
8	12-11-25	Ashiana-e-Korang	Farewell & celebration	